

A Question for Four Candidates

Connecticut 2026 · Governor, Senate 4, Senate 19, House 55 · One question asked of four Republican candidates, and a public record of the answers

A personal project by Scott Sauyet · scott.sauyet@gmail.com · I co-chair the Andover Democratic Town Committee; this page is my own work and not an official document of any committee, town, or campaign

On September 10, 2026 I sent the same question, in the same words, to four Republican candidates on Connecticut ballots this November. This page records who was asked, at what address, on what date, and what each has said in response. Any answer I receive will be published here in full and unedited, whether I like it or not, with the date it arrived. Contact addresses come from each committee's registration with the State Elections Enforcement Commission or from the campaign's own published contact page, and both are cited below. Where this page says no answer has been received, that is a statement about my inbox on the date shown, and nothing more. I am a Democrat and I co-chair the Andover Democratic Town Committee. I am asking anyway, and readers can weigh that as they see fit.

INTRODUCTION

Overview

I have one question for the Republicans asking for my vote this year, and I would rather put it to them directly than guess at the answer. The question is whether they will publicly disavow Donald Trump: a statement in their own name that he does not represent them and does not have their support.

That is not a question about a policy, a bill, or a vote in Hartford. It is a question about the head of the party whose banner every one of these candidates runs under, and every one of them has had a decade to decide what they think of him.

Four candidates were asked, on the same day, in the same words. Three of them appear on my own ballot in Andover. The fourth lives in a town that shares a House district with mine. All four are participants in Connecticut's Citizens' Election Program with grants awarded, meaning each asked the public to finance his or her campaign, and the public agreed.

This page is the record. It will be updated as answers come in, through Election Day on November 3, 2026. There is no deadline. An answer at any point gets added.

The question, as sent

The body of all four emails was the same but for the salutation, the sentence identifying the district, and one paragraph noted below. The question itself read:

Will you publicly disavow Donald Trump? By that I mean a statement in your own name that he does not represent you and does not have your support. Not a comment on a single policy, and not a statement about the party in general.

Each letter disclosed that I co-chair the Andover Democratic Town Committee, offered to publish the reply in full and unedited, offered to link an answer given anywhere else instead, and invited correction if the candidate had already answered publicly and I had missed it.

One paragraph appeared only in the letter to Sen. Fazio, noting that he has discussed his own past votes for Mr. Trump and has said he would welcome Mr. Trump's endorsement, and that the question here is whether he will disavow him now.

Each letter is published here in full, exactly as sent:

Letter	Sent	Text
Scott Sauyet to Fazio	September 10, 2026	read (http://andoverct.info/reports/ahm/disavowal/correspondence/2026-09-10-sauyet-fazio/)
Scott Sauyet to Jennings	September 10, 2026	read (http://andoverct.info/reports/ahm/disavowal/correspondence/2026-09-10-sauyet-jennings/)
Scott Sauyet to Guidone	September 10, 2026	read (http://andoverct.info/reports/ahm/disavowal/correspondence/2026-09-10-sauyet-guidone/)
Scott Sauyet to Weir	September 10, 2026	read (http://andoverct.info/reports/ahm/disavowal/correspondence/2026-09-10-sauyet-weir/)

WHO WAS ASKED

Part 1 — Who was asked, and where

Candidate	Office sought	Address used	Source of address
Ryan Fazio	Governor	info@ryanfazio.com	Campaign contact page
Jenn Jennings	State Senate, 4th	jennjennings4senate@gmail.com	Campaign contact page
Jason Guidone	State Senate, 19th	jason.guidone@proton.me	SEEC committee registration (Form 1A)
Steve Weir	State Rep., 55th	steve@steveweirforct.com	SEEC committee registration (Form 1A)

Notes: The letter to Rep. Weir was copied to his legislative address, Steve.Weir@housegop.ct.gov, because I am one of his constituents and that is the address his office staffs. The letter to Sen. Fazio was copied to press@ryanfazio.com, the second address listed on his contact page. All four committees are Citizens' Election Program participants with grants awarded, per the Secretary of the State's 2026 candidate registration list.

THE RECORD

Part 2 — The ledger

Candidate	Asked	Answered	Status as of September 17, 2026
Ryan Fazio	Sep 10, 2026 (http://andoverct.info/reports/ahm/disavowal/correspondence/2026-09-10-sauyet-fazio/)	—	No response yet
Jenn Jennings	Sep 10, 2026 (http://andoverct.info/reports/ahm/disavowal/correspondence/2026-09-10-sauyet-jennings/)	—	No response yet
Jason Guidone	Sep 10, 2026 (http://andoverct.info/reports/ahm/disavowal/correspondence/2026-09-10-sauyet-guidone/)	—	No response yet
Steve Weir	Sep 10, 2026 (http://andoverct.info/reports/ahm/disavowal/correspondence/2026-09-10-sauyet-weir/)	—	No response yet

Notes: This table is the whole point of the page, and it is deliberately boring. A dash means no reply had reached me as of the date in the column heading. It does not mean the candidate has never spoken about Mr. Trump, and it does not mean a reply was not sent. Anyone who believes a row is wrong should write to me and I will correct it within 24 hours.

Correspondence

Everything sent or received since the four opening letters, newest first. Each entry links to the message as formatted for reading, with the original source alongside it: raw headers for email, and a link, screenshot, and archive copy for anything published elsewhere.

Date	Item	Source
—	Nothing yet beyond the four letters above.	—

Notes: Replies will be published in full and unedited, whatever they say, with the date received. Anything a candidate says publicly elsewhere in answer to this question will be added here too, with a link to the original and an archived copy in case it moves.

STANDARD

Part 3 — What counts as an answer

Every reply will be classified, and the classification stated plainly beside it, on this scale:

Disavowal

An unambiguous statement in the candidate's own name that Mr. Trump does not represent them and does not have their support.

Criticism

Objection to a specific act, decision, or policy, without withdrawal of support. This is a real answer and will be published as one. It is not a disavowal, and will not be described as one.

Deflection

The question was answered with something else: a pivot to state issues, a statement that the candidate does not agree with everything the President does, or a reply about the party rather than the man.

Support

A statement that the candidate does support Mr. Trump. This is also a real answer, and an honest one. It will be published in the same words and given the same prominence as any other.

No response

Nothing received. Reported as of a date, never as a permanent condition.

BACKGROUND

Part 4 — What the public record already shows

Before sending the question I looked at what these candidates have already said in the venue where they speak most deliberately: their paid advertising.

Every Meta political ad attributable to each candidate's own page was collected and read on three channels, namely the ad text the platform publishes, the words printed on the image or video, and the words spoken aloud in it.

Meta advertising, all four candidates ✓ *Collected September 9, 2026*

Candidate	Ads	Mentions of Trump or MAGA
Ryan Fazio	135	0
Steve Weir	18	0
Jason Guidone	31	0
Jenn Jennings	0	n/a

Notes: Seven of the eighteen Weir ads were readable; the rest are ads Meta has removed, and the removal notice supports no conclusion about what they contained. Behind the zeros: 1,882 distinct video frames read by optical character recognition, about 50,000 characters of on-screen text recovered, and 57 minutes of audio transcribed. Ms. Jennings has never run a political ad on Meta, so advertising contributes nothing to her row in either direction. This is a paid-media finding only. Organic posts on the candidates' pages were not collected, so this table cannot show, and does not claim, that a candidate has never mentioned Mr. Trump.

The count is the weak version of the finding. The stronger version is what the advertising does discuss. Sen. Fazio's ads return repeatedly to immigration and federal enforcement, at length and in his own voice, and reach for the phrase "federal authorities" rather than the name of the President who directs them. The single instance of the word "administration" in nearly an hour of recorded audio refers to Gov. Lamont's.

Mr. Guidone came through a contested Republican primary between February and August of this year, ran thirty-one ads, and criticized his opponent by reference to his record and his tenure without either man's advertising touching the President.

None of that is an accusation. It is the reason the question is worth asking rather than assuming.

PRECEDENT

Part 5 — Whether the ask is a fair one

A reasonable objection is that no Republican could answer this question and survive a primary, so asking it is a trap rather than an inquiry. The record suggests otherwise.

Themis Klarides led the Republican caucus in the Connecticut House from 2015 to 2021. During her 2022 campaign for the United States Senate she said she had not voted for Mr. Trump in 2020, casting a protest write-in for her predecessor as caucus leader instead. She said it in her own name, in public, while seeking her party's endorsement, and she won that endorsement on the first ballot with about 57 percent of the delegates. She has never reversed it.

In December of that year, two former Republican leaders of the state Senate, Len Fasano and John McKinney, published an opinion piece in the Hartford Courant arguing that the party "needs to reject" Mr. Trump as a candidate.

Two things should be said plainly about those examples. All three were former officeholders rather than sitting ones when they spoke, and all three statements date to 2022. No sitting Connecticut Republican legislator has made a comparable statement in 2025 or 2026. The ask is answerable, and it has been answered before, but not recently and not by anyone currently in office.

Summary

Question	Answer
What was asked?	Whether the candidate will publicly disavow Donald Trump, in his or her own name.
Who was asked?	Fazio, Jennings, Guidone, and Weir, on September 10, 2026.
Was everyone asked the same thing?	Yes, in the same words, on the same day.
How many have answered?	None as of September 17, 2026.
Will answers be published?	Yes, in full, unedited, whatever they say.
Is silence proof a candidate supports Mr. Trump?	No. It is proof of nothing beyond itself.
Has any Connecticut Republican ever answered this way?	Yes, but not recently, and not while holding office.

TAKEAWAYS

Key Observations

The question is about the man, not the party. Every candidate here runs under Mr. Trump's banner because he leads their party. That is a fact about the ballot, not an accusation about the candidate. What each of them thinks of him is something only that candidate can supply.

Being asked and being accused are different things. Nothing on this page asserts that any of these four candidates supports Mr. Trump, admires him, or has ever said a word about him. The page records a question and whatever comes back.

Silence is not evidence. A blank row means the mail has not arrived. Voters can decide for themselves what to make of an unanswered question, and different voters will reasonably decide differently.

The public is paying for these campaigns. All four candidates take part in the Citizens' Election Program and have been awarded grants. That confers no legal obligation to answer anyone's questions, and this page claims none. It does mean the campaigns are publicly financed, and a voter who notices that is not being unreasonable.

An answer ends the matter, whatever it says. A candidate who replies "I support him," in those words, has answered honestly and will be recorded as having done so, in the same type as everyone else.

Corrections are welcome and will be made quickly. If a candidate has already answered this question somewhere I have not looked, the correction belongs on this page more than the omission does.

LIMITS

What this report does not show

It does not show that any candidate has never discussed Mr. Trump. Only paid advertising was collected. Organic posts on the candidates' own Facebook pages, their remarks at forums and debates, their interviews, and their answers to other people's questions were not systematically searched, and any of those could contain a statement this page has missed.

It does not show that the question was received, read, or seen by the candidate. Email to a campaign address is not certified mail.

It does not show that a non-answer is a considered choice. Campaigns are busy, inboxes overflow, and a message can be lost without anyone deciding anything.

It does not show anything about candidates who were not asked. Four Republicans were written to because they appear on my ballot or in my House district. Others on Connecticut ballots this year were not, and their absence from this page means only that.

It is not a neutral document. I wrote it, I am a Democrat, and I would like these candidates to answer. What is offered here is not the absence of a point of view but a record specific enough that a reader who disagrees with me can check every part of it.

DOCUMENTATION

Sources

Candidate websites

- Steve Weir for CT, steveweirforct.com (<https://steveweirforct.com/>)
- Jenn Jennings 4 Senate, jennjennings4senate.com (<https://jennjennings4senate.com/>)
- Ryan Fazio for Governor, ryanfazio.com (<https://ryanfazio.com/>)
- Jason Guidone for Senate, [guidoneforsenate.com](https://www.guidoneforsenate.com/meet-jason) (<https://www.guidoneforsenate.com/meet-jason>)

Candidate contact information

- Connecticut State Elections Enforcement Commission, committee registration filings (SEEC Form 1A), searchable at [seec.ct.gov](https://seec.ct.gov/Portal/eCRIS/eCrisSearch) (<https://seec.ct.gov/Portal/eCRIS/eCrisSearch>)

- Jenn Jennings 4 Senate, campaign contact page, [jennjennings4senate.com](https://jennjennings4senate.com/contact/) (<https://jennjennings4senate.com/contact/>)
- Ryan Fazio for Governor, campaign contact page, [ryanfazio.com](https://ryanfazio.com/contact/) (<https://ryanfazio.com/contact/>)
- Connecticut General Assembly member directory, for Rep. Weir’s legislative address, [cga.ct.gov](https://www.cga.ct.gov/) (<https://www.cga.ct.gov/>)

Candidate status and program participation

- Connecticut Secretary of the State, Candidate Registration List for Election Year 2026
- CT News Junkie, coverage of the Republican state convention, May 16, 2026, [ctnewsjunkie.com](https://ctnewsjunkie.com/2026/05/16/ct-republicans-back-fazio-for-governor/) (<https://ctnewsjunkie.com/2026/05/16/ct-republicans-back-fazio-for-governor/>)

Advertising record

- Meta Ad Library, collected September 9, 2026. Method and coverage boundaries documented separately; ad-level records retained.

Prior Connecticut examples

- CT Mirror, May 7, 2022, on Themis Klarides and the Republican Senate endorsement, [ctmirror.org](https://ctmirror.org/2022/05/07/ct-gop-endorses-a-social-moderate-themis-klarides-for-us-senate/) (<https://ctmirror.org/2022/05/07/ct-gop-endorses-a-social-moderate-themis-klarides-for-us-senate/>)
- CT News Junkie, December 7, 2022, on the Fasano and McKinney opinion piece, [ctnewsjunkie.com](https://ctnewsjunkie.com/2022/12/07/op-ed-mckinney-fasano-tell-spoiled-child-trump-to-get-lost/) (<https://ctnewsjunkie.com/2022/12/07/op-ed-mckinney-fasano-tell-spoiled-child-trump-to-get-lost/>)

Correspondence

- Every letter, reply, and public answer relating to this question, with original sources: [correspondence](http://andoverct.info/reports/ahm/disavowal/correspondence/) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/ahm/disavowal/correspondence/>)

DOWNLOAD

Other Formats

This report is available in three formats, all located alongside this page:



HTML

Interactive version with formatted tables; best for on-screen reading.



Markdown

Plain-text version; readable in any editor, ideal for copying elsewhere.



PDF

Print-ready version with all tables, footnotes, and source citations.

*Personal work of Scott Sauyet · Compiled September 17, 2026, and updated as
answers arrive*

*Contact addresses from candidate committee filings with the Connecticut State
Elections Enforcement Commission and from the campaigns' own websites. Not an
official town document.*

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